

LOGIC AND CRITICAL THINKING

LoCT (1011)

- ❑ General Descriptions of the Course
 - ❖ It consists **5 chapters** Namely:-
 - **Introduction to philosophy**
 - **Basic concepts of logic**
 - **Logical Discourse & Languages**
 - **Critical Thinking**
 - **Fallacies: - Informal/ Formal Fallacies**

CHAPTER ONE:

Introduction to philosophy

❑ Meaning and Nature of Philosophy

- ❖ Definition: Defining the term philosophy is **controversial** and **no clear cut** definitions. **Why?**
- ❖ **No specific subject matter** to primarily deal with. Rather, it deals with **issues which are universal in nature.**

Cont..

- ❖ Socrates advocates that, "Wonder is the feeling of philosophers, and philosophy begins in wondering".
- ❖ Etymologically, the term driven from Greek words:-
 - philo- means Love
 - Sophia - means wisdom;
- hence, philosophy is love of wisdom.

Cont....

- ❖ For **Pythagoras**; the term used to **refers to a person who clearly shows a marked curiosity/eager to explore and understand in the things he experiences/ world.**
- ❖ But, it consist critical habits. Example:-
 - **What is love?**
 - **What is wisdom?**

Cont...

- ▶ Thus, **philosophy** is :
- ✓ **a pursuit of wisdom,**
- ✓ **development of critical habits,**
- ✓ **continuous search for truth, and**
- ✓ **the questioning of the apparent.**

Examples of Questions in Philosophy

- Does God exist?
 - What is reality?
 - What is the ultimate source of Being?
 - What is knowledge?
 - What does it mean to know?
 - How do we come to know? Etc...
- **Note: - Questioning in philosophy is not an end in itself, but the ways to philosophy.**

Cont....

- ❑ So, **philosophy** is a **rational** and **critical enterprise that tries to answer the fundamental questions.**
- It has **constructive** and **critical sides**
- It is an **activity** and is **not some that can be easily learned in school.**
- It requires **extra ordinary ability.**

Features of philosophy

- ✓ Is a **set of views, beliefs about life and the universe**
- ✓ Is a **process of reflecting on and criticizing**
- ✓ Is the **logical analysis of languages, words and concepts.**
- ✓ A science that **sought answer for the questions.**

Core Fields of Philosophy

These include:-

Metaphysics ,
Epistemology
Axiology ,
Ethics ,
Aesthetic , and
Logic

Metaphysics

- ❖ It is **things after physics**, because; **Meta** means **beyond**, **up on** and **after**; whereas **physics** means **physical nature**.
- ❖ So, it is the **branch of philosophy** that studies the **ultimate reality beyond nature or existence**.

Example:-Issues of God, freedom, **Soul or immortality**, mind-body relationship, **cause-effect**, etc.

Some of the questions of Metaphysics are

- What is reality?
- What is the ultimately real?
- What is the nature of the ultimate reality?
- Is it one thing or is it many different things?
- Can reality be grasped by the senses, or it is transcendent?
- What makes reality different from a mere appearance?
- What is mind, and what is its relation to the body?
- Is there a cause and effect relationship between reality and appearance?

Cont....

- Does God exist, and if so, can we prove it?
- Are human actions free, or predetermined by a supernatural force?
- What is human being? A thinking mind? A perishable body? Or a combination of both?
- What is time?
- What is the meaning of life?

Aspects of Metaphysics

- ❑ **Metaphysics** can be sub-divided in to **four aspects**.

These are:-

- **Cosmological, theological, anthropological , and ontological.**

Cont...

1. Cosmological aspects:-

- It **theorizes** about the **origin, nature and developments of the universe as orderly system.**

□ Example:

- How did the universe originate and develop?
- Did it come by accident or by design?

Aspects of metaphysics

2. theological aspect:-

- It deals with the **concepts of God**.

□ Example:-

- ✓ Is there God? If there, is there one or more than one?
- ✓ What are attributes of God?

Cont....

3. Anthropological Aspect: -

- ❖ Is study of human beings and asks questions like the following:
 - What is the relation between mind and body?
 - Is mind more fundamental than body, with body depending on mind, or vice versa?
 - What is humanity's moral status?
 - Are people born good, evil, or morally neutral?
 - To what extent are individuals free? Do they have free will? Etc.

Cont.....

4. Ontological Aspect:

- ❑ Is the study of **nature of existence**, or **what it means for anything to exist**.
- ❑ Asks Questions Like:
 - Is basic reality found in matter or physical energy (the world we can sense), or is it found in spirit or spiritual energy?
 - Is it composed of one element (e.g., matter or spirit), or two (e.g., matter and spirit), or many?

cont..

- Is **reality orderly** and **lawful in itself**, or is it merely orderable by the human mind?
- Is it **fixed** and **stable**, or is change its central feature? Is this reality friendly, unfriendly, or neutral toward humanity?

2 Epistemology

- ▶ The word **epistemology** has been derived from the **Greek words**
- **episteme**, meaning —**knowledge**, **understanding**||, and
- **logos**, meaning —**study of**.
- Thus, it **studies** about **the nature**, **scope**, **meaning**, and **possibility of knowledge**.

The basic questions are:

- ✓ What is knowledge?
- ✓ What is true?
- ✓ How do we know?
- ✓ What is the source of knowledge? Experience? Reason? Or both?
- ✓ What makes knowledge different from belief or opinion?
- ✓ What is the relationship and difference between faith and reason?

Sources of knowledge

A). Reason (Rationalism)

- ❑ Senses are **not helpful** and **reliable** means **to knowledge**;
- Senses means **to opinion** and **thought**; so, **Knowledge** becomes **more reliable** as we **move perception** to **pure reason**!
- Plato's divide line: the two worlds vs knowledge vs division of labor and the philosopher kings.
- **Plato's tripartite** element(**Reason**, **Spirit** and **Appetite** or **Desire**) and types of soul vs knowledge.

Cont...

B). Senses (5): empiricism

- Aristotle's stance: **Mind is tabula rasa;**
Inseparability of FORM and OBJECT
- **Senses** are **windows** to the mind that help human beings to **communicate** with the external environment.

C). Intuition (Foundationalism) : The **direct apprehension of knowledge** that is **not derived** from **conscious reasoning** or **immediate sense perception**

Cont....

D). Revelation: religious knowledge.

- ❖ It differs from all other sources of **knowledge** because it presupposes a **transcendent supernatural reality** that breaks into the natural order.
- The **knowledge obtained** via it is “**absolute** and **uncontaminated**.”
- Such **knowledge** must be accepted by **faith** and **cannot be proved** or disproved empirically or rationally.

Cont..

E). Authority:

❑ Authoritative **knowledge** is **accepted as true** because it comes **from experts** or has been sanctified over time as tradition.

❑ **Example:**

- ✓ textbook,
- ✓ teacher, or
- ✓ reference books.

3. Axiology

- ❑ It is the study or **theory of value**.
- ▶ Comes from **two Greek words**-
 - ✓ **Axios**, meaning —**value, worth**, and —
 - ✓ **logos**, meaning —**reason/ theory/ symbol / science/study of**.
- Therefore, **Axiology** is the **philosophical study of value**, which originally meant the **worth of something**.

Cont.....

❑ **Common Questions:**

- What is a value?
- Where do values come from?
- How do we justify our values?
- How do we know what is valuable?
- What is the relationship between values and knowledge?
- What kinds of values exist? And, Who benefits from values? Etc.

4. Ethics

- ❑ Also known as **Moral Philosophy**,
- is a science that **deals** with the philosophical **study of moral principles, values, codes, and rules**, which may be used as standards for determining what kind of human conduct/action is said to be good or bad, right or wrong.
- ❑ **Some Questions:**
 - ✓ What is moral, right or the opposite?
 - ✓ What are the standards to evaluate human actions?

Sub-fields of Ethics

There are (3)

Normative Ethics:-
Search for human
conducts

**Teleological ethics/
Consequentialism**

Deontological Ethics/

Virtue Ethics

Cont...

2. Meta-ethics:

- ❑ Deals with investigation of the **meaning of ethical terms** like what is **moral, good, immoral, right** etc.

- ❑ Includes:-

Moral Intuitionism,

Moral Emotivism,

Moral Prescriptivism,

Moral Nihilism, and

Ethical Relativism are of in its realm of study.

Cont...

3) Applied Ethics:

❖ **Attempts** to explain, justify, apply moral rules, principles, standards, and positions to **specific moral problems**, such as **capital punishment, euthanasia, abortion, adultery, animal right**, and so on.

5. Aesthetics

- ❑ It deals with **beauty**, **art**, **enjoyment**, **sensory/emotional values**, **perception**, and matters of taste and sentiment.
- ❑ **Some basic Questions:**
 - What is art?
 - What is beauty?
 - What is the relation between art and beauty?
 - What is the connection between art, beauty, and truth?
 - Can there be any **objective standard** by which we may judge the beauty of artistic works,
 - ▶ or **beauty is subjective**?

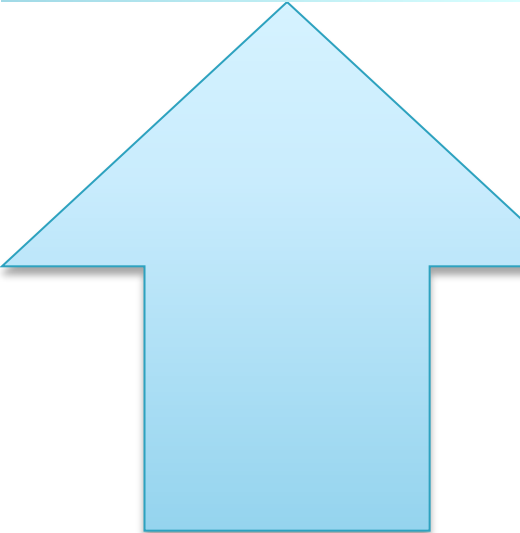
6. Logic

- ❑ The study or **theory of principles of right reasoning**.
 - It deals with formulating the **right principles of reasoning**; and **developing scientific methods of evaluating the validity and soundness of arguments**.
- ❑ **Some basic questions:**
 - What is an argument; What does it mean to argue?
 - What makes an argument valid or invalid?
 - What is a sound argument?
 - What relation do premise and conclusion have in argument?
 - How can we formulate and evaluate an argument? What is a fallacy?;
 - What makes an argument fallacious?

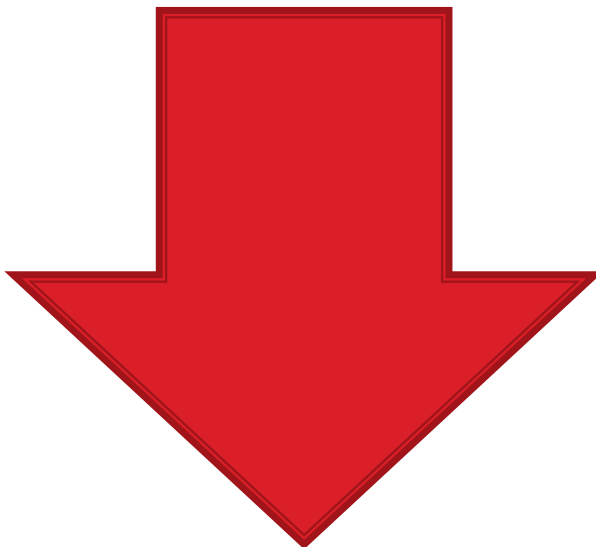
Importance of Learning Philosophy

- ❑ *“The unexamined life is not worth living”- Socrates.*
- ❖ **Intellectual and Behavioral Independence;**
- ❖ **Reflective Self-Awareness;**
- ❖ **Flexibility, Tolerance, and Open-Mindedness;**
- ❖ **Creative and Critical Thinking; and**
- ❖ **Conceptualized and well-thought-out value systems in morality, art, politics.**

END OF CHAPTER ONE



**Thank you
For your attention**



**Chapter two
Basic Concepts of
Logic**